Review the following scenario. Then complete the step-by-step instructions.

You are a level one security operations center (SOC) analyst at a financial services company. You have received an alert about a suspicious file being downloaded on an employee's computer.

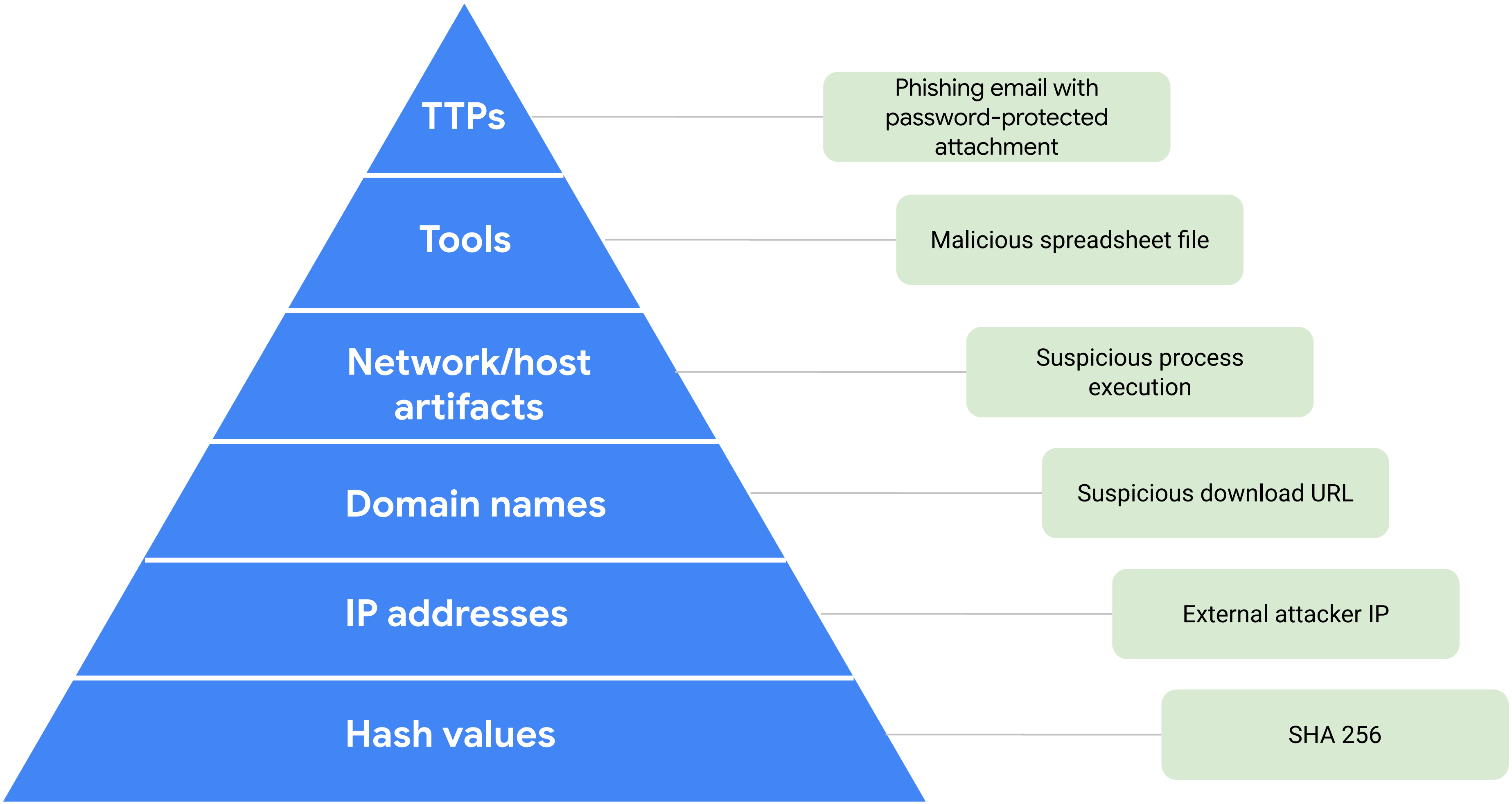
You investigate this alert and discover that the employee received an email containing an attachment. The attachment was a password-protected spreadsheet file. The spreadsheet's password was provided in the email. The employee downloaded the file, then entered the password to open the file. When the employee opened the file, a malicious payload was then executed on their computer.

You retrieve the malicious file and create a SHA256 hash of the file. You might recall from a previous course that a hash function is an algorithm that produces a code that can't be decrypted. Hashing is a cryptographic method used to uniquely identify malware, acting as the file's unique fingerprint.

Now that you have the file hash, you will use VirusTotal to uncover additional IoCs that are associated with the file.

Has this file been identified as malicious? Explain why or why not.

Yes, the file has been identified as malicious. VirusTotal shows that multiple security vendors detect the file as malware based on its SHA256 hash. The file behavior and detection results indicate that it contains a malicious payload that executes when opened, confirming it is unsafe.


TTPs
Tools
Network/host artifacts
Domain names
IP addresses
Hash values
Phishing email with password-protected attachment
Malicious spreadsheet file
Suspicious process execution
Suspicious download URL
External attacker IP
SHA 256